

ALLISON BURNS

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SENIOR AI PRODUCT MANAGER with 7+ years experience and 10 years in retail, generating \$840M+ in revenue through Applied AI solutions across Fortune 1, 20, 150 and startup companies. Creatively inspired by human cognition to advance AI systems and experiences.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

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|---------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------|
| ✓ AI Experiences | ✓ Retrieval-Augmented Generation | ✓ Augmented Reality |
| ✓ AI Infrastructure | ✓ Computer Vision | ✓ User Journey Mapping |
| ✓ Agentic AI | ✓ 2D-to-3D Image Generation | ✓ AI Product Strategy |
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & ACHIEVEMENTS

Home Depot | New York, NY **2024 - Current**

Senior AI Product Manager | GenAI

- **Leadership.** Created the North Star vision for all GenAI Products, aligning strategic objectives across the B2C and B2B product portfolios in an interim AI leadership capacity to drive innovation and organizational alignment.
- **Strategy.** Developed the AI product strategy and roadmap for a 0-1 consumer-facing AI agent with human-like intelligence, targeting 2M MAUs by the end of 2025 and expected to drive \$300M in annual revenue through a 5% conversion lift.
- **Execution.** Collaborated with DataScience to develop and launch 3 [GenAI prototypes](#) (Review Summarization, Product Q&A Assistant, & Magic Apron [Shopping Assistant](#)) with rapid time to market for the purpose of incubating a RAG architecture, data ingestion pipeline, and custom LLM integration.
- **Collaboration.** Piloted a federated operating model to streamline cross-functional collaboration and improve efficiency across 4 Data Science and Engineering teams.

Walmart Global Tech | Hoboken, NJ **2022 - 2024**

Senior AI Product Manager | Computer Vision

- **Platform.** Led AI infrastructure and tooling experiences, achieving a 50% reduction in the model development lifecycle and improving the accuracy of automated solutions deployed onto hardware in Walmart stores as part of a \$10B cost-reduction effort.
- **Applications.** Supported Computer Vision applications including item recognition on NextGen Checkout prototypes, an event detection system on forklifts pilot, and a globally scaled theft detection system on self checkout units, saving \$420M in inventory loss over two years.
- **Infrastructure.** Accelerated the model Evaluation framework by integrating tools for offline simulation, traceability, and test reproducibility. Collaborated closely with data scientists to improve developer experiences and practices which contributed to increases in solution accuracy. Key partnerships included [Google Vertex AI](#), [Weights & Biases](#), [Voxel51](#).
- **Scalability.** Informed the North Star vision for Computer Vision and partnered with leadership to establish a platform strategy focused on multimodal solutions, model reusability, and platform scalability to enable the path to fully autonomous Walmart stores.
- **Leadership.** Piloted a matrixed operating model and directly managed another Product Manager in optimizing data pipelines by improving Ground Truth representation, ensuring alignment with real-world conditions.

Aedit | New York, NY **2021 - 2022**

Senior AI Product Manager | Computer Vision

- **Leadership.** First Product hire, led 2 UX designers, 6 developers, and partnered closely with 6 Computer Vision Researchers to deliver experience products using applied research in ML & 2D-to-3D modeling.
- **Application.** A category defining health/beauty product that predicts and simulates plastic surgery results on potential patients before a procedure. [Featured on Allure Beauty](#)
- **Users.** Led user research efforts to validate R&D initiatives, understand the user's perception of the product, the user's level of trust in AI, and to inform features that enhance the AI UX.
- **Growth.** Launched growth features to drive app downloads and grew a user base of over 100k plastic surgery patients and over 300 board certified plastic surgeons, establishing the app as a trusted and valuable resource within the medical community.

Macy's | New York, NY**2015 - 2021****AI Product Manager | Innovation Lab****2019 - 2021**

- **Impact.** Led the innovation lab that pioneered AI & Augmented Reality products in retail which increased conversion by 5% and drove \$60M annually, contributing \$120M over my 2 years in the role.
- **Application.** Launched the industry leading ["See it in 3D"](#) product using 2D-to-3D generation models to replace human created videos with interactive synthetic data for scalable e-commerce user experiences.
- **Influence.** Achieved 80x ROI and published a case study which led to widespread adoption of the use case across competitors in the retail industry. [Featured on Nvidia](#)
- **Partnerships.** Led strategic partnerships with AI and Augmented Reality startups, collaborating directly with CEOs to develop and launch POCs and A/B tests. Internally evangelized emerging technologies to secure funding for scaled partnerships from the Chief Product Officer. Ex: [AR Beauty](#) [AR Furniture](#)
- **Leadership.** Grew the innovation lab's reputation and influence within the organization, leading a team of 2 designers and 15 engineers while cultivating an engaged audience of 100+ active stakeholders.

AI Product Operations Manager | Innovation Lab**2018 - 2019**

- **Ownership.** Partnered cross functionally with product, engineering, and business teams to manage the deployment and post deployment operations for AI and Augmented Reality POCs launched by the innovation lab.
- **Execution.** Led the product interlock process, developing business cases and preparing for discussions and decisions with Senior Leadership on product prioritization and new investments to drive business growth through innovation.
- **Collaboration.** Cultivated and maintained strong relationships with executives, peers, and stakeholders, resulting in effective communication channels and go to market strategy.

Associate Site Merchandise Manager | Home**2017 - 2018**

- **Ownership.** Drove operational excellence to inc sales & engagement of a \$3B revenue driving business.
- **Data Driven.** Analyzed site traffic, revenue, & conversion metrics to drive business optimization tactics.

Assistant Site Merchandise Manager | Handbags & Accessories**2016 - 2017**

- **Ownership.** Drove operational excellence to inc sales & engagement of a \$3B revenue driving business.
- **Data Driven.** Analyzed traffic, revenue, & conversion metrics to drive business optimization tactics.

Merchandise Coordinator | Site Operations**2015 - 2016**

- **Execution.** Drove operational excellence through automating attribution to tag over 500k products.
- **Result.** Enabled accurate site navigation, search results, filtering, reporting, and machine learning.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS**Machine Learning Certificate:** Stanford University**2020****Professional Program | UX Design:** University of California, Berkeley Extension**2019****Bachelor of Arts | Design:** University of California, Davis**2015****Environmental Design:** UC Davis Study Abroad Program**2013****ADDITIONAL SKILLS & ACTIVITIES**

- Product Coach on Jobs to Be Done Framework - coached product teams ranging from 20-100 people
- Thought leader and creator of empowered product & innovation team culture
- **AI podcast listener:** Boz to the Future, Lenny's Podcast, NVIDIA AI Podcast, Road to Autonomy
- **Current favorites on Cognitive Science & the human mind:**
The Body Keeps the Score by Dr. Bessel van der Kolk, Outshining Trauma by Ralph De La Rosa (Psychotherapist), Internal Family Systems (IFS) Framework by Richard C. Schwartz, Ph.D, The Art of Accomplishment podcast by Joe Hudson (Tech Executive Coaching through applied spiritual, psychological, and neurological practices)